



Presentation Skills

An effective presentation is well-structured, uses engaging audiovisual elements, and is delivered with attention to both verbal and non-verbal communication. Certified Technical Architects deliver various presentations and need to know how to captivate the audience and move them to action.

Types of presentations

Technical Architects may need to conduct the following types of presentations:

- Seeking funding for new projects in ServiceNow
- Showcasing ServiceNow's capabilities with the business for new initiatives
- Presenting the architectural blueprint to achieve business objectives
- Technical evaluation results of strategic and operational demands in ServiceNow
- Supporting organizational change management activities with business owners
- Leading requirement gathering workshops with customers
- Demonstrating platform capabilities
- Defending leading practice solutions highlighting the importance of avoiding customizations to prevent technical debt
- Presenting a solution for validation and sign-off

Leading practices for effective presentations

Tips for effective preparation:

- Allow yourself enough time to be fully prepared
- Deliver the right content, in the right way, to the right people
- Ensure you practice your entire presentation out loud to a trusted colleague, or record yourself and watch the recording to identify areas for improvement

Time management:

- You must never overrun your allocated time, and you must be conscious of any interruptions that consume your time to ensure that all your content is delivered

Time reduction considerations:

- Postpone topics to follow up sessions



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- Summarize some areas to compensate for an important question that needs time to be answered
- Ask participants about the knowledgeability of some areas to reduce the required time and make room for more Q&A

Presentation structure

Ensure your presentation has a clear structure, starting with preparation.

1. **Preparation** includes analyzing the audience's needs and defining your objectives
2. The **opening** prepares the audience for the scope and sequence of your presentation or dialogue
3. The **body** includes the material to support the key points or ideas in your opening
4. Your **closing** concludes the audience interaction with a summary of your presentation and a requested action (It is similar in structure to the opening)
5. **Following up** on action items reflects your interest and keeps the audience's interest

Non-verbal skills

When your nonverbal signals match up with the words you're saying, they increase trust, clarity, and rapport. Ensure you work on the following non-verbal skills:

- Confidence
- Physical attributes
- Gestures and body movements
- Eye contact with your audience

Audiovisuals

Only use an audiovisual if it supports a point you are making. Pick an audiovisual that works with your room size, audience preference, level of audience involvement, and your comfort level. Ensure audiovisual elements are consistent across your presentation.